

Adding Fractions

Like fractions are fractions that have the same denominator. For example, $\frac{1}{8}$ and $\frac{3}{8}$ are like fractions. $\frac{1}{8}$ and $\frac{2}{4}$ are **unlike fractions** because they have different denominators.

To add like fractions, just add the numerators. The denominator remains the same.

$$\frac{1}{8} + \frac{3}{8} = \frac{4}{8} \leftarrow 1 + 3 = 4$$

The answer to an addition or subtraction problem may need to be simplified. Always write your answers in lowest terms. Change improper fractions to mixed numbers.

Example

Hide

$$\frac{5}{8} + \frac{4}{8}$$

Step 1
Add the numerators.

$$\frac{5}{8} + \frac{4}{8} \leftarrow 5 + 4 = 9$$

Step 2
Place the result over the denominator.

$$\frac{5}{8} + \frac{4}{8} = \frac{9}{8} \leftarrow 5 + 4 = 9$$

Step 3
Change to a mixed number if necessary.

$$\frac{9}{8} = \begin{array}{r} 1 \text{ R} 1 \\ 8 \overline{) 9} \end{array} = 1\frac{1}{8}$$

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Lesson 5: Operations with Fractions

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